

Proper names in the ERG: Revising the analysis

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Current status in ERG

- Lexicon for 2025 contains about 7000 lexical entries for names
- Lexicon for ERG+WN contains about 3000 names found in WN
- These include names of months, days, holidays (idiosyncrasy)
- Also include rivers, mountain ranges (idiosyncrasy with “the”)
- Also include people, airports, continents, countries, states, cities, islands religions, mythological figures, drinks, royal dynasties, alphabet letters, diseases, holidays, companies, products
- Also abbreviations: Del., U.S., D.C.

Names can be multi-token and include conjunctions

- Mary Smith, Mr. Bill M. Jones Jr.
- Mary and Bill Smith, the Smiths
- Crater Lake, Lake Erie, the Rocky Mountains, the Rockies
- the University of Washington, Cal State Fresno
- the War of 1812, the Vietnam War
- Rio de Janeiro, Gran Asuncion
- ANA (airline) vs. Ana (person's name)
- IBM (not Ibm or ibm), HP (sometimes Hp, usually not hp)
- McDonald's, A&W, Taster's Choice, the New York Times, Yahoo!
- UBS Phillips & Drew, Prince George's County
- Washington DC, Washington, D.C., Wash. D.C.
- the U.S. and Hong Kong economies

Grounding in Wordnet or Wikidata

- Wordnet has sparse coverage of named entities
- Wikidata has 120 million entries with unique identifiers
- Includes “also known as” for alternate names
- Includes hyponym relations (often multiple ones)

Issues

- Follow OEWN in moving to Wikidata anchors
- ERG/MRS: change headedness of multi-token names
Mary and Bill Smith are ...
**Mary Smith and Jones are ...*
- For each anchored proper name lex-entry, add generic one
- MRS: use same pred name “named_rel” or “named_n_rel” for all